Suggestibility Questionnaire

A suggestibility questionnaire is designed specifically to assess physical or emotional suggestibility and it focus on how individuals respond to suggestions through either physical sensations or emotional experiences. This questionnaire is to understand how you take in or interpret information. As this trait is frozen during teen-age and remains constant thereafter, most of the questions need you to think of situations during your teenage and how you responded to them most of the time.

The following is a conditioned response test designed to help Hypnotherapist assist you more rapidly with your program. It is important that you answer these questions truthfully, keeping in mind there are no “right” or “wrong” answers. Go with the first answer that comes to mind after you read the question. Try not to dwell on any question. Simply check “Yes” or “No” beside each question. If there has been no practical experience, imagine how you might have interacted during your teenage in those situations and answer. Please answer all the questions in both sheets. Follow instructions on score sheet below.

Scoring

1. Count the number of YES answers to Questionnaire 1. Question no. 1 and 2 score 10 points each if answered YES. Each remaining (question 3-18) YES scores 5 points each.
2. Total each Questionnaire separately for both the applicable '10' and '5' YES scores.
3. Add the totals of both Questionnaires to find the COMBINED Total.
4. Divide the score of Questionnaire 1 by the Combined Total and multiply it with 100. This indicates the percentage of Physical suggestibility.
5. Subtract the score from 100 to determine the percentage of Emotional suggestibility.

Physical Suggestibility: A/(A+B) X 100 = _____ % (PS)
Emotional Suggestibility: 100 – (PS) = _____ % (ES)

Indications in Suggestibility Questionnaire

- “YES” answers to Questionnaire No. 1 are indicative of Physical Suggestibility as they show physical suggestible behaviour.
- “YES” answers to Questionnaire No. 2 are indicative of Emotional Suggestibility as they show emotional suggestible behaviour.

Suggestibility Questionnaire 1			
1	Have you ever walked in your sleep during your adult life?	YES	NO
2	As a teenager, did you feel comfortable expressing your feelings to one or both of your Maternal and Paternal figures?	YES	NO
3	Do you have a tendency to look directly into people's eyes and/or move close to them when discussing an interesting subject?	YES	NO
4	Do you feel that most people you meet for the first time are uncritical of your appearance?	YES	NO
5	In a group situation with people you have just met, would you feel comfortable drawing attention to yourself by initiating a conversation?	YES	NO
6	Do you feel comfortable holding hands or hugging someone you are in a relationship with while other people are present?	YES	NO
7	When someone talks about feeling warm physically, do you begin to feel warm also?	YES	NO
8	Do you occasionally have a tendency to tune out when someone is talking to you, and at times not even hear what the other person is saying, because you are anxious to come up with your side of it?	YES	NO
9	Do you feel that you learn and comprehend better by seeing and/or reading than by hearing?	YES	NO
10	In a new class or lecture situation, do you usually feel comfortable asking questions in front of the group?	YES	NO
11	When expressing your ideas, do you find it important to relate all the details leading up to the subject so the other person can understand it completely?	YES	NO
12	Do you enjoy relating to children?	YES	NO
13	Do you find it easy to be at ease and comfortable with your body movements, even when faced with unfamiliar people and circumstances?	YES	NO
14	Do you prefer reading fiction rather than non-fiction?	YES	NO
15	If you were to imagine sucking on a sour, juicy, yellow lemon, would your mouth water?	YES	NO
16	If you feel that you deserve to be complemented for something well done, do you feel comfortable if the compliment is given to you in front of other people?	YES	NO
17	Do you feel that you are a good conversationalist?	YES	NO
18	Do you feel comfortable when complimentary attention is drawn to your physical body or appearance?	YES	NO

Suggestibility Questionnaire 2			
1	Have you ever awakened in the middle of the night and felt you could not move your body and/or could not talk?	YES	NO
2	As a child, did you feel that you were more affected by the tone of voice of your Maternal and Paternal figures than by what they actually said?	YES	NO
3	If someone you are associated with talks about a fear that you too have experienced, do you have a tendency to have an apprehensive or fearful feeling also?	YES	NO
4	If you are involved in an argument with someone, after the argument is over do you have a tendency to dwell on what you could or should have said?	YES	NO
5	Do you have a tendency to tune out occasionally when someone is talking to you, perhaps not even hear what was said, because your mind has drifted to something totally unrelated?	YES	NO
6	Do you sometimes desire to be complemented for a job well done, but feel embarrassed or uncomfortable when complemented?	YES	NO
7	Do you often have a fear or dread of not being able to carry on a conversation with someone you have just met?	YES	NO
8	Do you feel self-conscious when attention is drawn to your physical body or appearance?	YES	NO
9	If you have your choice, would you rather avoid being around children most of the time?	YES	NO
10	Do you feel that you are not relaxed or loose in body movements, especially when faced with unfamiliar people or circumstances?	YES	NO
11	Do you prefer reading non-fiction rather than fiction?	YES	NO
12	If someone describes a very bitter taste, do you have difficulty experiencing the physical feeling of it?	YES	NO
13	Do you generally feel that you see yourself less favourably than others see you?	YES	NO
14	Do you tend to feel awkward or self-conscious initiating touch (holding hands, kissing, etc...) with someone you are in a relationship with while other people are present?	YES	NO
15	In a new class or lecture situation, do you usually feel uncomfortable asking questions in front of the group even though you may desire further explanation?	YES	NO
16	Do you feel uneasy if someone you have just met looks you directly in the eyes when talking to you, especially if the conversation is about you?	YES	NO
17	In a group situation with people you have just met, would you feel uncomfortable drawing attention to yourself by initiating a conversation?	YES	NO
18	If you are in a relationship or are very close to someone, do you find it difficult or embarrassing to verbalize your love for him or her?	YES	NO

Altering Hypnosis to Suggestibility

Understanding whether a person is more physically or emotionally suggestible helps hypnotists choose the most effective techniques and suggestions.

For Physically Suggestible Individuals: Hypnotists might use more concrete, sensory, and direct suggestions. Techniques like progressive relaxation, arm levitation, and direct physical suggestions are often effective.

For Emotionally Suggestible Individuals: Hypnotists might use more abstract, emotional, and indirect suggestions. Techniques like visualization, metaphorical language, and emotionally charged narratives are often effective.

By recognizing and adapting to an individual's type of suggestibility, hypnotists can enhance the effectiveness of their sessions and achieve better therapeutic outcomes.

Laws of Suggestibility

The laws of suggestibility in hypnosis outline principles that help explain how and why people respond to hypnotic suggestions. These laws provide a framework for understanding how these suggestions are processed and accepted by the mind. They guide hypnotists in formulating effective suggestions and creating conditions that maximize the likelihood of achieving the desired outcomes. These laws were primarily developed by early hypnotists and psychologists to better understand the mechanisms of hypnosis. Here are some key laws of suggestibility:

Law of Concentrated Attention:

The more one concentrates on a particular idea or suggestion, the more likely it is to be accepted and acted upon. Focused attention enhances the absorption of the suggestion.

Example: If a hypnotist asks a subject to focus intensely on the idea of their hand feeling warm, the subject's concentrated attention on that sensation can cause the hand to actually feel warmer. The more the subject concentrates, the more likely they are to experience the suggested warmth.